Ironhack bootcamp outcomes: scaled up ~10×, placement collapsed — from their own data

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What actually happens after an Ironhack bootcamp — across all 6 tracks, cohort by cohort — built from Ironhack's own internal alumni directory.

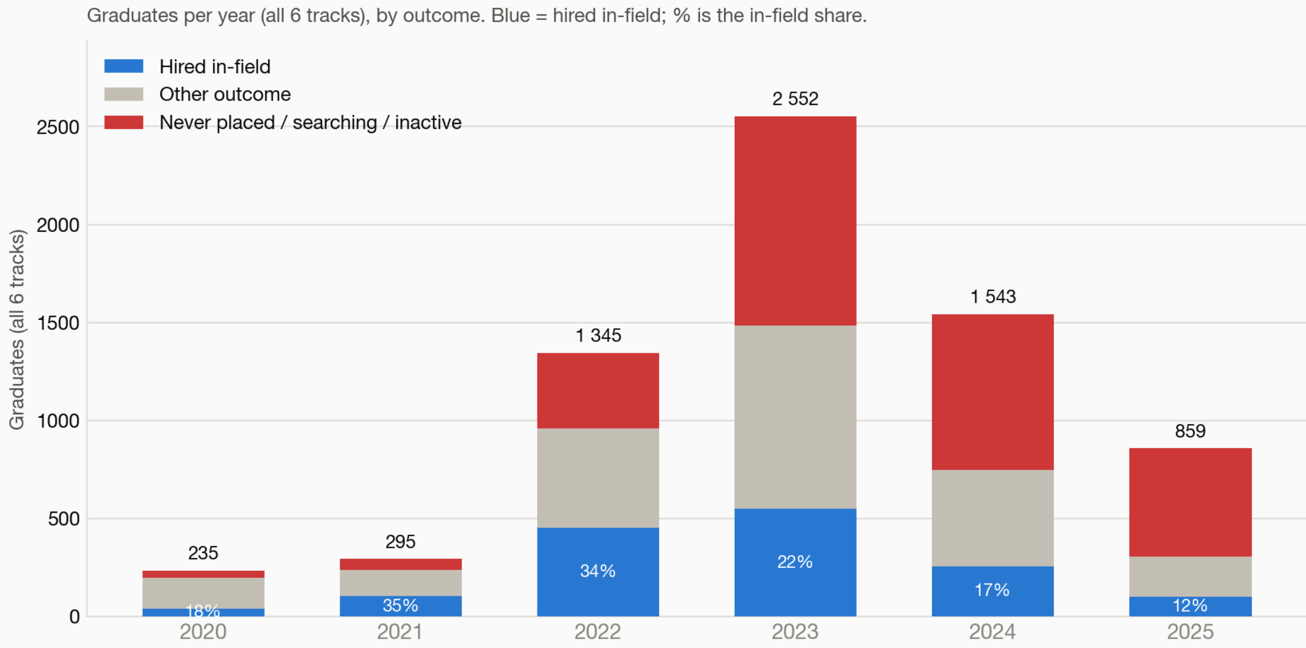
> This is a data-journalism exercise on Ironhack's **own system of record**: the alumni-portal directory (`my.ironhack.com`) where Ironhack itself logs each graduate's career-services outcome (accessed with an alumni login). Because it's the internal record and not a marketing page, it includes the failures too. Everything here is **aggregate and anonymous** — no individual is named, no raw personal data is republished. It's **not** an allegation of fraud. The story isn't one headline number; it's a **trend**: as Ironhack scaled to its largest cohorts ever and launched new premium tracks, the share of graduates actually hired *in-field* collapsed.

Contents

The big picture

Ironhack grew from a few hundred graduates a year to **thousands** — and over the same period, the share actually hired *in-field* fell from ~35% to ~11%.

Ironhack scaled up ~10× — and in-field placement collapsed



2024–2025 cohorts are still being populated in the directory (counts are floors). Source: Ironhack's own alumni directory, aggregated & anonymized.

Graduation year	Graduates (all 6 tracks)	Hired in-field	Never placed / searching
2020	235	17%	14%
2021	295	**35%**	19%
2022	1,345	33%	28%
2023	2,552	21%	41%
2024	1,543	16%	51%
2025	859	**11%**	64%

Two things happened at once, and together they're the story:

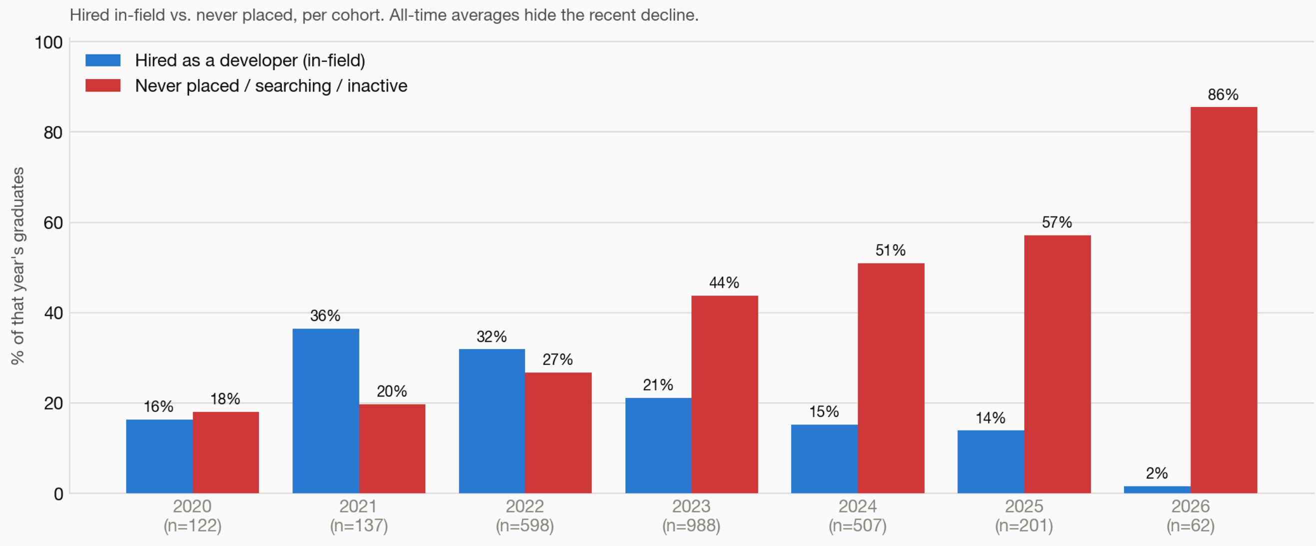
- **Scale.** Annual graduating cohorts grew **~10×** between 2020 and the 2022–2023 peak. These are the biggest classes in Ironhack's history.
- **Collapse.** In-field placement fell every year after the 2021 boom — from 35% to ~11%.

So the largest cohorts Ironhack ever enrolled are also the ones with the worst outcomes. In absolute terms the **2023 cohort alone has 1,066 graduates recorded as never placed / still searching**, versus 35 in 2020. *(2024–2025 counts are floors — the directory is still being populated for recent years — which makes the falling placement %, not the headcount, the reliable signal.)*

Across **~7,700 graduates in all 6 tracks**, this pattern holds everywhere. Per track:

Web Development

Web Development — outcomes by graduation year (Ironhack's own data)

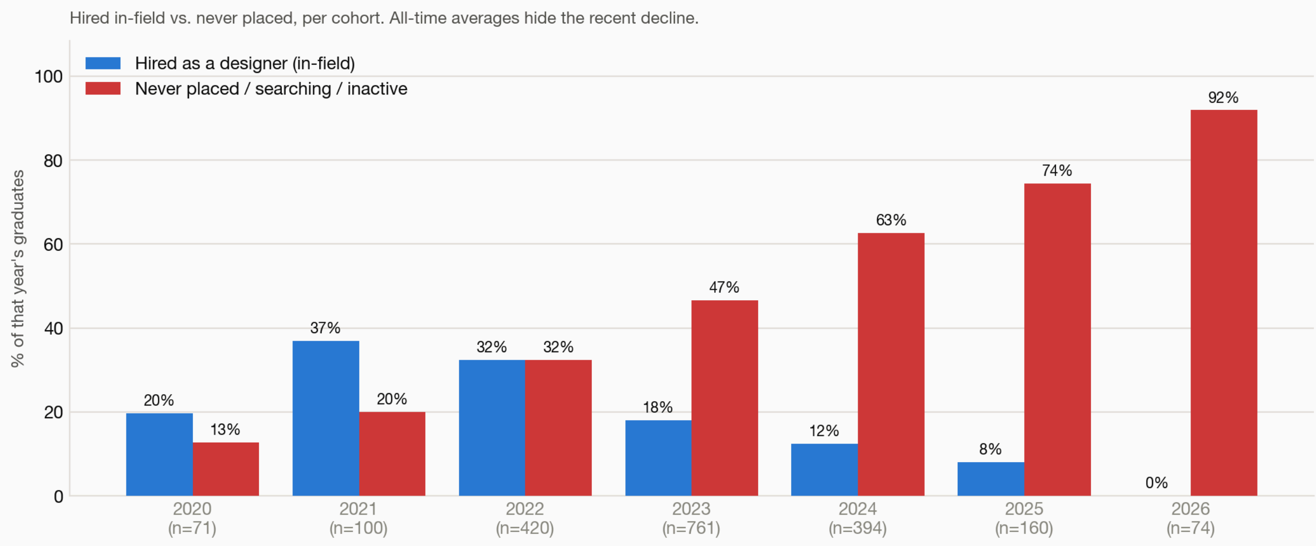


Source: Ironhack's own alumni directory, aggregated & anonymized. github.com/donneepublique/ironhack-ux-outcomes

2,832 grads. Hired as a developer in-field, by cohort: 2021 **36%** → 2022 32% → 2023 21% → 2024 15% → **2025 14%**, with **44–57%** of the last two cohorts never placed / still searching.

UX/UI Design

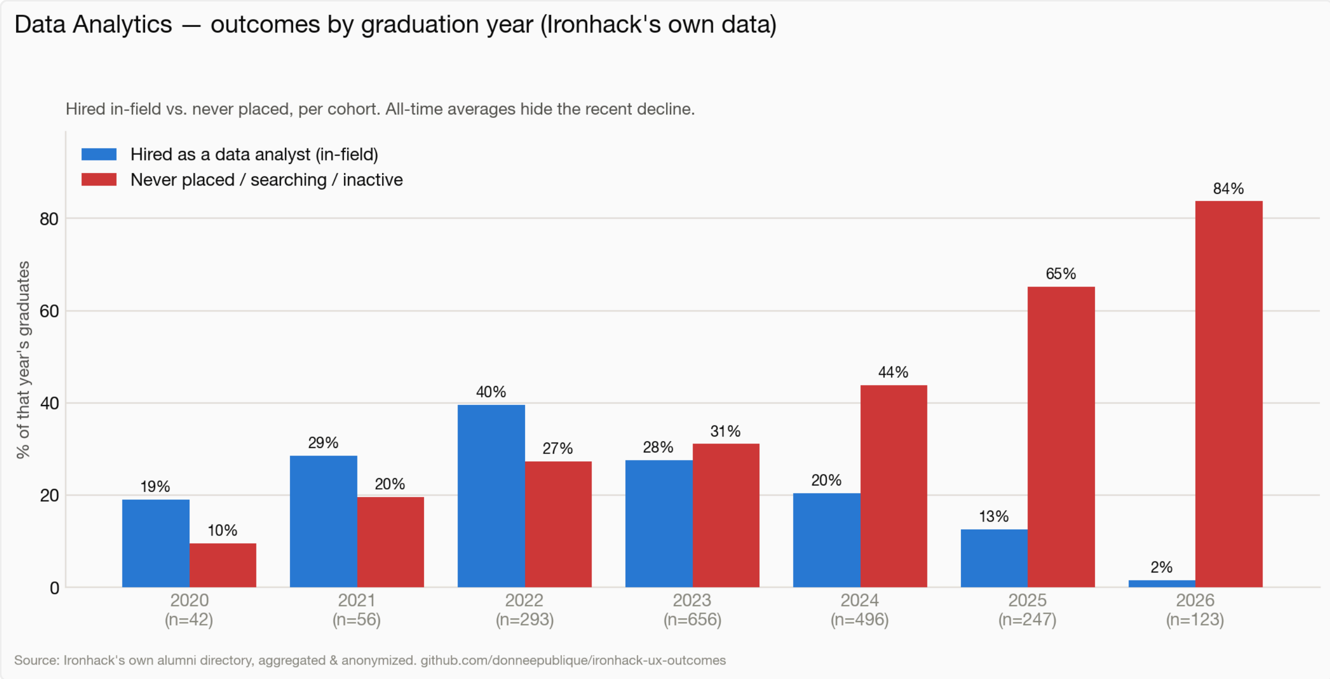
UX/UI Design — outcomes by graduation year (Ironhack's own data)



Source: Ironhack's own alumni directory, aggregated & anonymized. github.com/donneepublique/ironhack-ux-outcomes

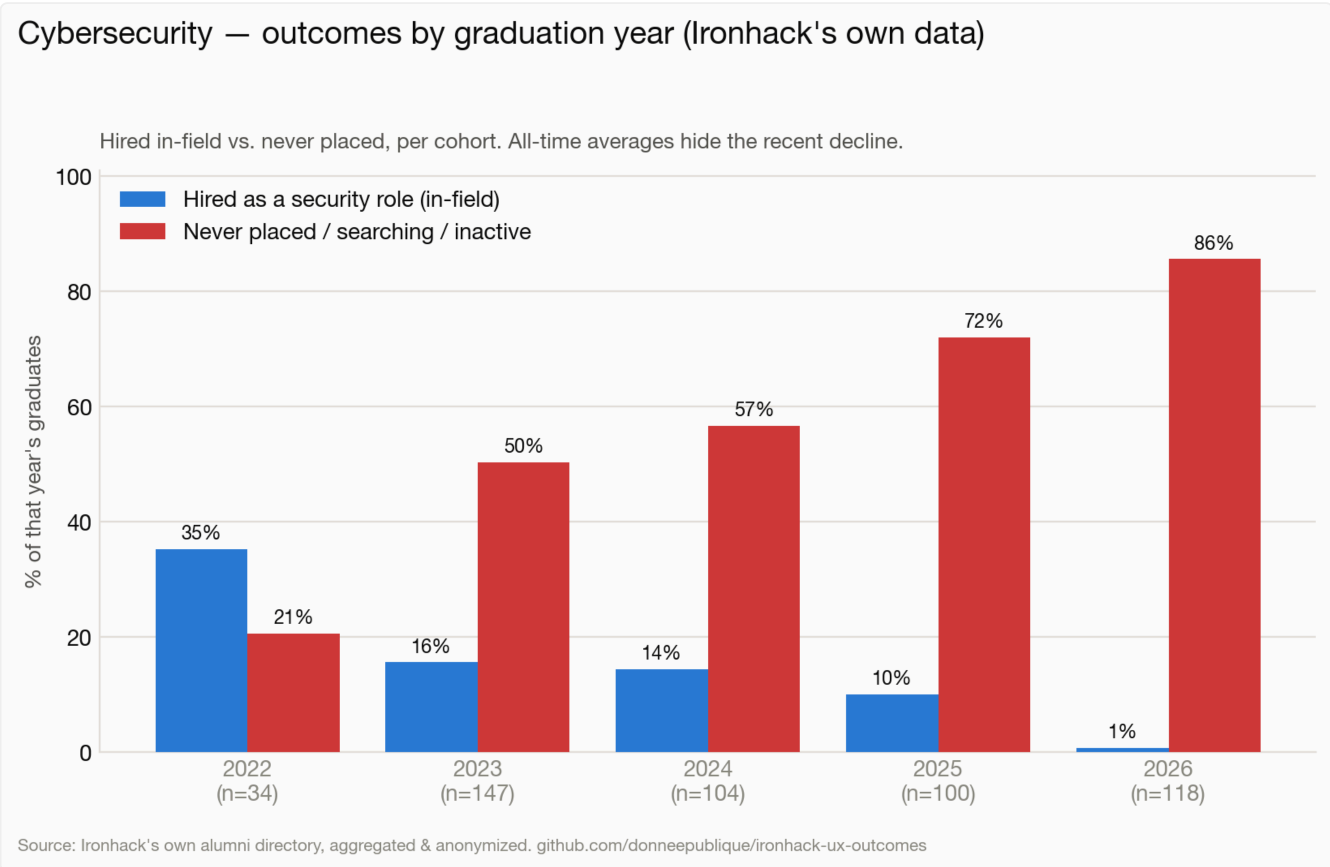
2,126 grads. Hired as a designer in-field: 2021 **37%** → 2023 18% → 2024 12% → **2025 8%**, with **63–74%** of recent grads never placed. It's also the track with the deepest per-campus and per-year breakdown — the remote campus (largest cohort) is the weakest.

Data Analytics



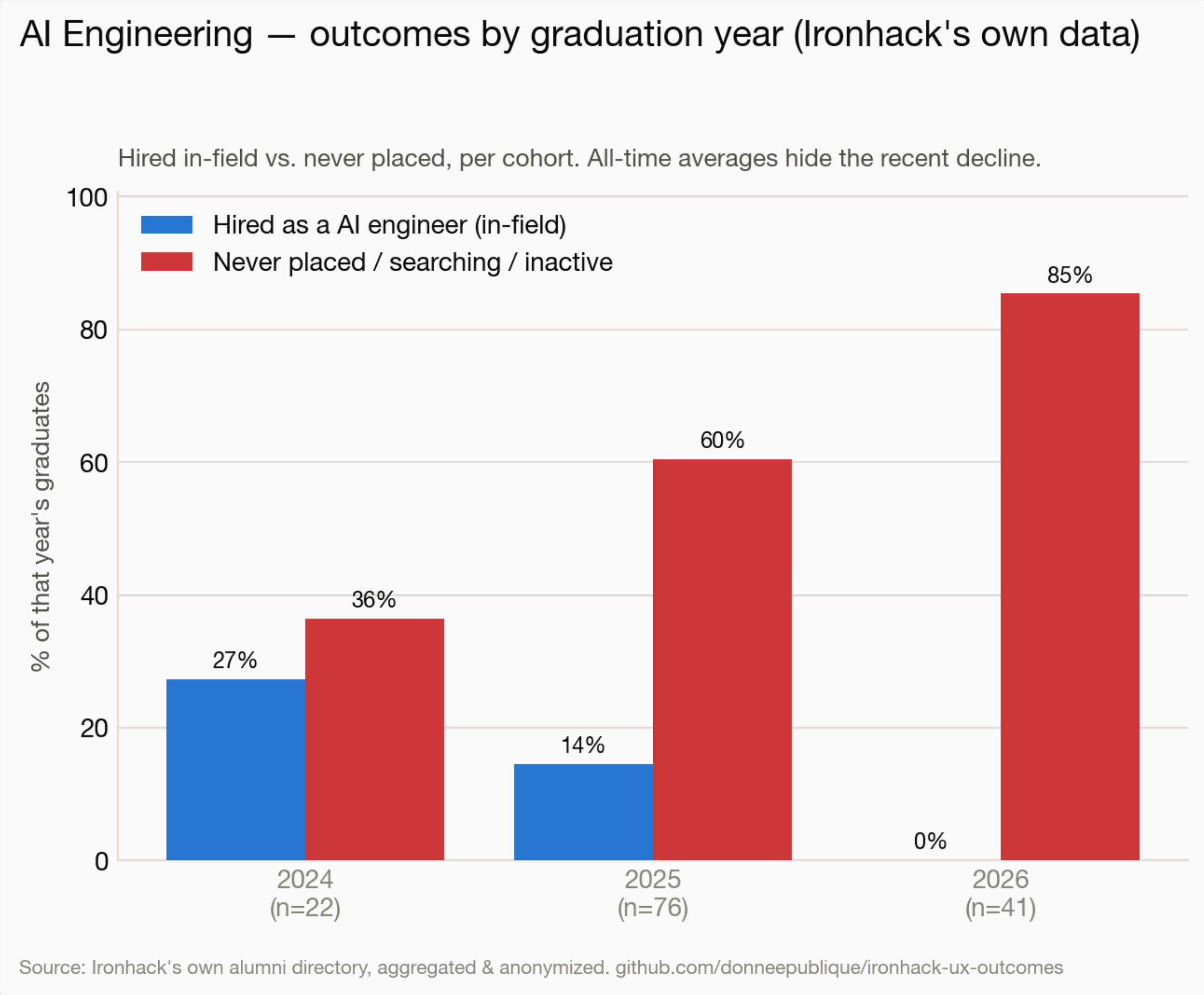
1,954 grads. Ironhack's *strongest* track — and still collapsing: 2022 **40%** → 2023 28% → 2024 20% → **2025 13%** (65% never placed).

Cybersecurity



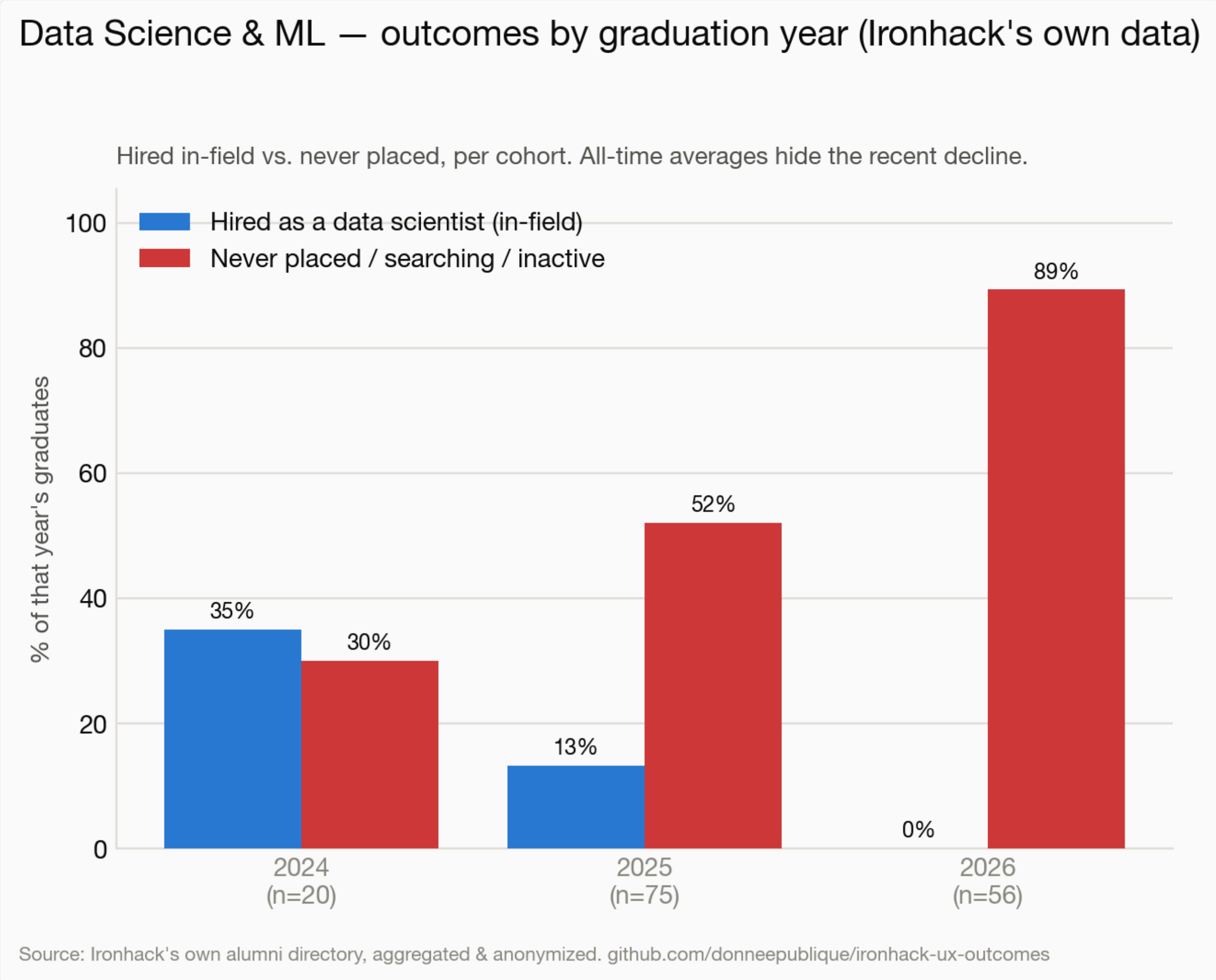
505 grads. 2022 35% → 2023 16% → 2024 14% → **2025 10%** hired in-field, with **57–72%** of recent grads never placed.

AI Engineering



139 grads (newest, priciest track). **2025 cohort: 14% hired in-field, 60% never placed** (n=76). Launched right as the market turned — and it shows.

Data Science & ML



151 grads. 2025 cohort: 13% hired in-field, 52% never placed (n=75) — the lowest in-field rate of any track.

How the "~90% placed" claim fits in

Around **2019**, Ironhack's *first* outcomes report (presented as PwC-audited) advertised "*we placed 90% of job-seeking graduates within 6 months*" (76% / 89% at 90 / 180 days). That number leaned on two moves: a **narrow denominator** (only "job-seeking" grads) and a **broad numerator** ("placed" = *any* job, including out-of-field or returning to a former employer). Recreate it generously on the full data and you reach ~**51%**, not 90%; count only *hired as a designer* ÷ *all graduates* and it's **18%** (UX/UI, all-time) — and, as shown above, far lower for recent cohorts. This ~6-year-old figure — pre-dating the market downturn — is **no longer displayed** (the page redirects; archived 2022 on the Wayback Machine); today's marketing is softer ("pay once you get a job", "land your first role"). It isn't the point of this report — the **trend and scale** are.

Method

- **Source:** `POST my.ironhack.com/api/alumni` — Ironhack's internal alumni-portal directory (accessed with an alumni login), its system of record for each graduate's `career_services.status`. Not a public marketing page, so it reports the real outcome spread, failures included.
- **Scope:** all 6 tracks (ux, wd, da, cy, ai, ml), every campus — **≈7,700 graduates**.
- **Ground truth:** Ironhack's own status labels, grouped into plain-language buckets. "Hired in-field" = `hired_in_field`; "never placed / searching" groups `placement_not_successful`, `searching`, `inactive`,

`intervention_*`, `deferred_*`, `pending`. Full mapping below.

- **By year:** cohorts are split by graduation year so recent classes aren't hidden inside boom-era averages.
- **Privacy:** published outputs are counts only.

▶ Full status → bucket mapping

Limitations

- **Ironhack's labels**, taken at face value; we don't know their exact internal definition of `placement_not_successful` or how often `searching` / `inactive` are refreshed.
- **Snapshot** (July 2026); recent cohorts (2024–2026) are still being populated, so their **headcounts are floors** — the reliable signal is the falling placement **%**, and the mature cohorts (2021–2023, 1.5–5 years out) already show the collapse.
- A handful of records carry a placeholder date (`1987`, Madrid) — excluded from the year charts, kept in totals.

Provenance & tamper-evidence

The capture is hashed into a Merkle root and **time-stamped by an independent RFC 3161 authority**, so it can't be quietly rewritten and survives any later deletion by Ironhack. The raw data can be provided **on request to legitimate funding or oversight bodies** for verification. Threat model + verification steps: PROVENANCE.md.

Ethics & privacy

- Source is Ironhack's **internal alumni directory**, accessed with an alumni account — their system of record, not a public page.
- **Nothing identifying is republished** — aggregate, anonymous counts only. Raw per-person data (names, LinkedIn, photos) is git-ignored and never leaves the analyst's machine.
- Ironhack's **own labels**, taken at face value — a comparison between marketing and documented outcomes, not an allegation of fraud.

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